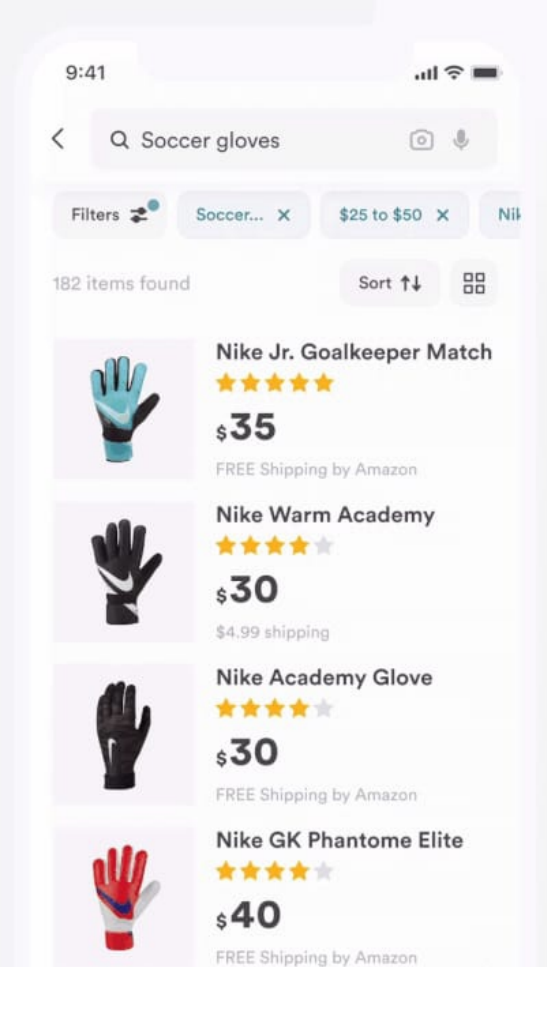
Amazon UX Case study

REDESIGN   IOS APP   2021



Check out our article to dig deeper into our case study

A UX Review is important to ensure that you can deliver the right solution that resonates with your audience. It should to be carried out across all products and services to ensure that customers are getting the best out of what your company offers.

Rather than glossing over the theories, we're going to show how Heuristic evaluation can be applied in a real example: The Amazon Shopping App.

Amazon shopping app overview

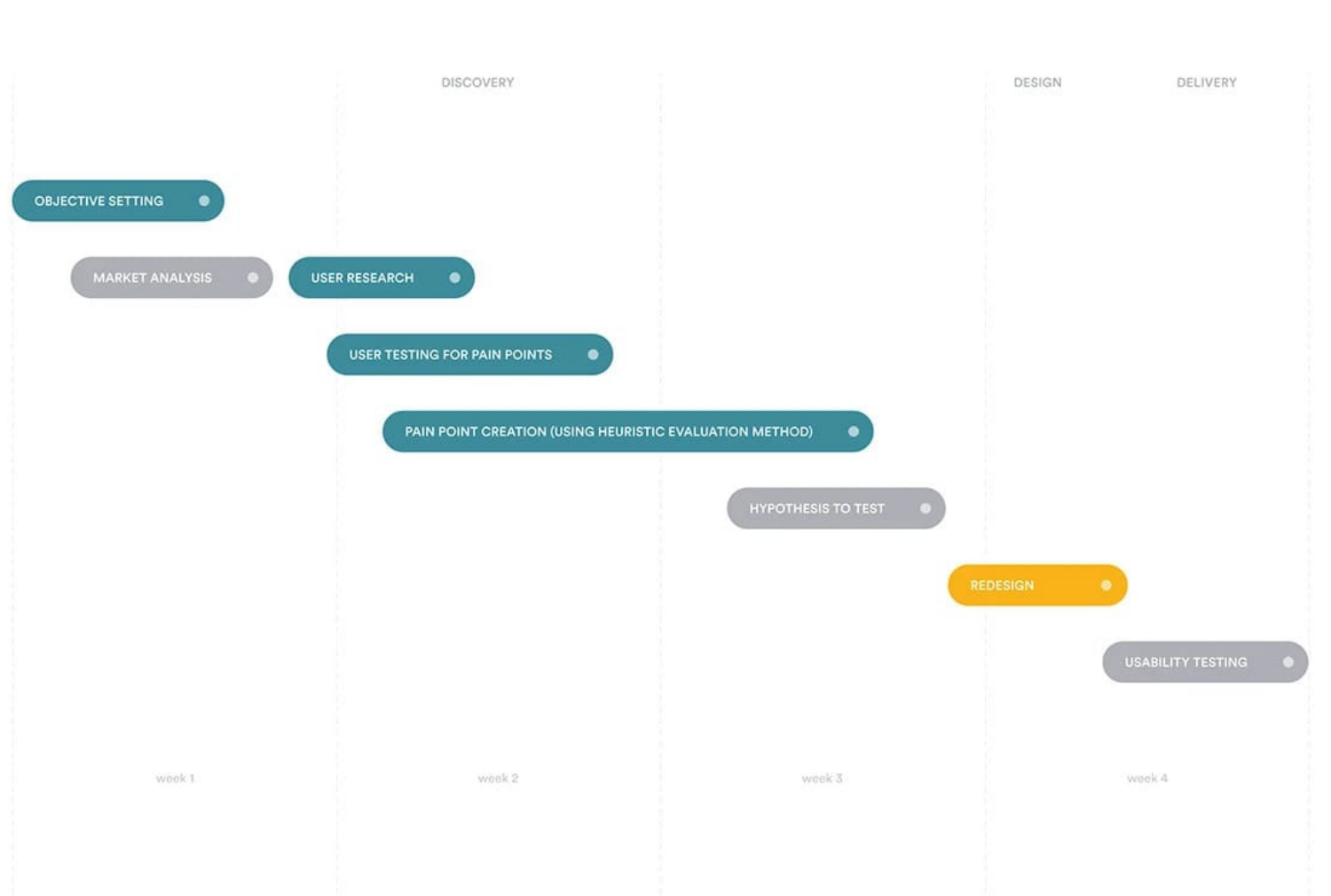
Existing buyers who have been shopping on Amazon for years may not be impacted by the changes as they are gradually introduced on the app.

However, a new user who is shopping on Amazon for the first time may find the home page overly-cluttered with hundreds of product images that are intersected with sponsored listings. There can also be a lack of uniformity in how the various category pages are designed.

In this UX case study, we will identify the pain points on the Amazon shopping app and determine how they can be improved to provide a better user experience.

Project stages

Expert reviews are a valuable method for uncovering usability issues, complementary to usability testing. UX Expert Review involves the following stages to identify usability problems and strengths.



Objective

To determine if new, unregistered users will have a smooth experience when shopping for products on Amazon's app.

User Research

User research helps us to analyze who uses the app and their experience.

An individual who is no stranger to using an online shopping platform
Takes the time to research a product thoroughly before purchasing. This shopper leverages features on the app and is attentive to details.

A young shopper who is only using the app for essential goods
Takes time to compare products and is particularly interested in eco-friendly products. This shopper annoyed by ads during online shopping.

A professional executive who likes to shop spontaneously
This shopper has little time to browse through different products and would like to make quick decisions from the available information.

An online marketer on the lookout for the best deals and prefers online shopping to physical stores
Ideally, this shopper prefers quality products and wanted to shop in a secure environment.

James, 25 y.o.

San Francisco (USA)
Marketer | Not married | No children

NEEDS
- To search and buy cheaper goods
- To save time (don't stand in lines)
- To have a large selection of goods and services in one place

DESIRES
- Wants to buy quality items
- Wants to shop quickly and safely
- Wants to find any product that he needs without spending a lot of effort

FEARS
- Afraid of receiving poor quality goods
- Afraid that the seller will not be honest
- Afraid of buying items that don't live up to expectations

Maria, 22 y.o.

New York (USA)
Eco-activist | Not married | No children

NEEDS
- To find the cheapest items
- To compare the prices of items
- To buy safely
- To buy only essentials goods

DESIRES
- Only necessary items
- Wants to save money
- Wants to find items that are eco-friendly

FEARS
- Afraid to buy unnecessary items
- Afraid of not finding necessary and eco-friendly items
- Afraid of ads' influence on her

Customer Journey Map

A Customer Journey Map is a detailed infographic that reflects the entire journey of a customer's interaction with a product. CJM helps to look at the business through the buyer's eyes to understand their goals, motives, expectations, and fears.

	PHASE | SEARCH	PHASE | GOODS PAGE	PHASE | THE CART	PHASE | PLACE ORDER
ACTIONS	Enter the name of the item in the search field Change the current location Filter selection View goods in the results list	Selection of specific functions (size, color, etc.) View product descr. and details View customer reviews Add to cart	List of all previously added goods Check the shipping address Proceed to checkout	Order total Shipping details Payment method Place order
THOUGHTS	Will I find the eco-friendly product that I want? How will the search results change if I change the location? Will the filter help me display more accurate results? There are so many goods	Is there a product with the parameters that I need (size, color, etc.)? I want to be confident in the product that I buy I will not buy an item with a low rating, but I can buy the cheapest product How to add two items?	How to restore a deleted item to the cart? Will I be able to change the address if I choose the wrong one Is it the last step?	It is imperative to double-check everything Let's check one more time Hope it doesn't take long Can I return an item if it doesn't fit me?
EMOTIONS				
OPPORTUNITIES	Autocomplete the search Show saved locations and the current location (GPS) More personalised filters Add to Favourites	Amount selection differs from the search page Second-level page navigation Filter for reviews	Opportunity to restore the deleted item in one click Opportunity to choose bonuses Change the number of units for an individual product	Show total amount Select the right one or add a new one Change shipping address

User Testing For Pain Points

Here are the results that validated our earlier findings.

CONFUSED   NOT STRUCTURED   MANY ADS   TOO MUCH INFO   HARD TO COMPARE ITEMS

- The product page is hard to navigate, has too much info, and is not structured
- Too many ads
- Confused by the search results
- Confused by purchase screen - need to verify the info multiple times
- Can't add to favorites on the search results page
- Hard to compare items. It takes too long to return to the search screen

The Amazon app heuristic evaluation example

For heuristic analysis, it is recommended to involve three to five participants. This increases the effectiveness of the method and allows you to detect more usability problems in the interface. This is individual work that is carried out by each participant separately. After completing the work, all the data are combined. This allows you to get independent and unbiased estimates.

The result of the evaluation by heuristic analysis is a list of problems with the interface's usability with links to those principles of usability that were found in the design.

Current design

SEARCH & RESULTS PAGE

POSITIVE FINDINGS

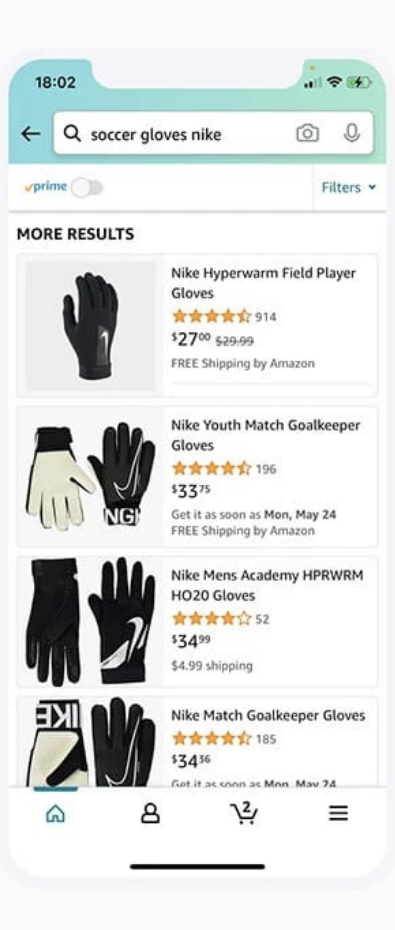
- ✓ User can choose the option that suits him/her from those that the system offers
- ✓ The search history is saved
- ✓ The system returns the right option despite errors when typing the product name in the search bar
- ✓ Search with hints after entering a pair of characters

NEGATIVE FINDINGS

VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS
Incomprehensible number of search results

VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS
There is no normal page pagination, the user does not understand how many pages of products there are

AESTHETIC AND MINIMALIST DESIGN
Instead of indicating the items are not delivered to a specific country, the system should hide those non-deliverable items from the customer's view.

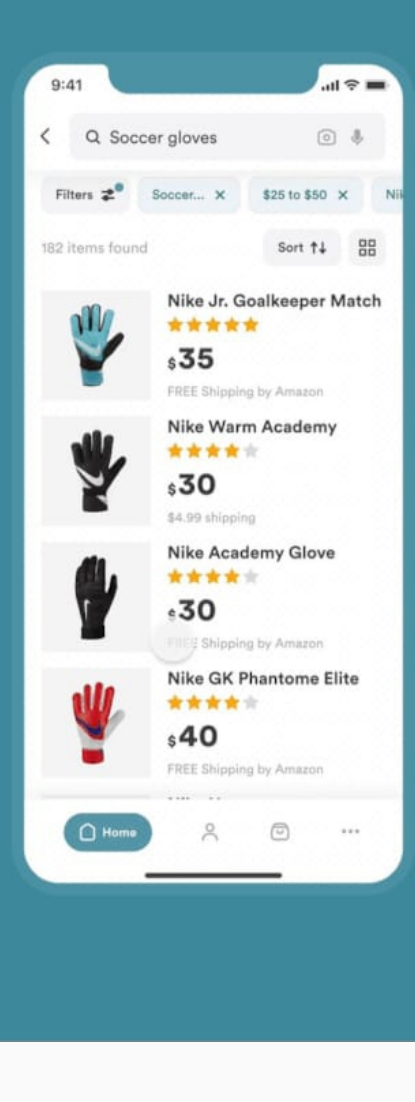

18:02
soccer gloves nike
prime
Filters
MORE RESULTS
Nike Hyperwarm Field Player Gloves
$27.00
FREE Shipping by Amazon
Nike Youth Match Goalkeeper Gloves
$33.75
Nike Mens Academy HPRWRM HO20 Gloves
$34.99
$4.99 shipping
Nike Match Goalkeeper Gloves
$34.36

Upgrade design

SEARCH & RESULTS PAGE

CHANGES MADE TO DESIGN

- ✓ Changed the display of cards with the product, highlighted the main and secondary information
- ✓ Added number of search results
- ✓ Added pagination of the page so that the user can return to the page he needs
- ✓ Changed padding between elements, more space for better separation of information



Current design

PRODUCT PAGE

POSITIVE FINDINGS

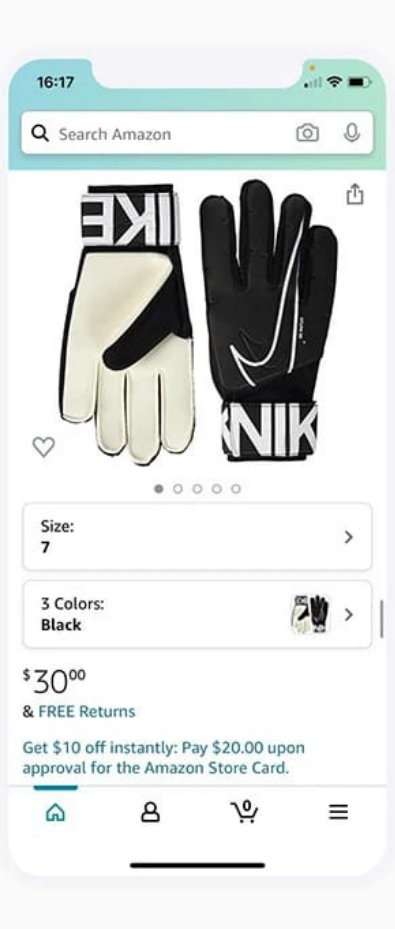
- ✓ Interaction, which helps to understand that the product has been added the cart (animation)
- ✓ When scrolling the screen, a "Back to Top" button appears

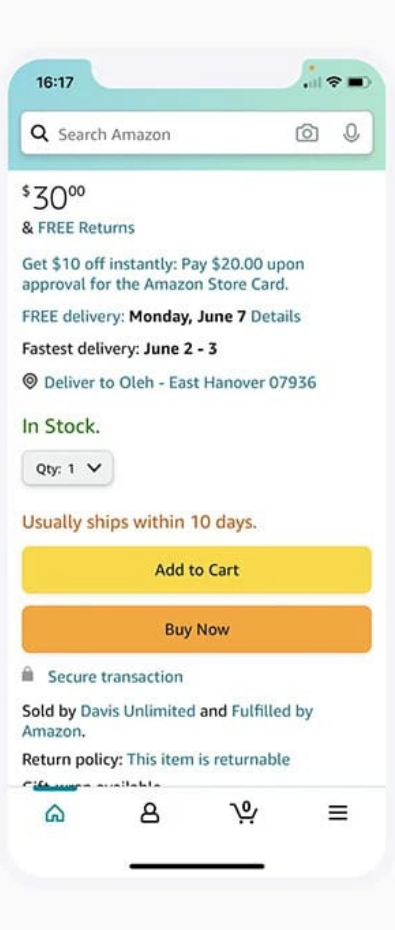
NEGATIVE FINDINGS

CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS
The choice of color and size can be visually displayed differently for different products

VISIBILITY OF SYSTEM STATUS
Users see the product's size, but it can be hard to understand which one the customer needs

MATCH BETWEEN SYSTEM AND THE REAL WORLD
Some products sizes are shown in numbers, but users may expect them to be shown in more familiar local taxonomies and presented in a table


16:17
Search Amazon
Size:
7
3 Colors:
Black
$30.00
& FREE Returns
Get $10 off instantly: Pay $20.00 upon approval for the Amazon Store Card.


16:17
Search Amazon
$30.00
& FREE Returns
Get $10 off instantly: Pay $20.00 upon approval for the Amazon Store Card.
FREE delivery: Monday, June 7 Details
Fastest delivery: June 2 - 3
Deliver to Oleh - East Hanover 07936
In Stock.
Qty: 1
Usually ships within 10 days.
Add to Cart
Buy Now
Secure transaction
Sold by Davis Unlimited and Fulfilled by Amazon.
Return policy: This item is returnable

NEGATIVE FINDINGS

FLEXIBILITY AND EFFICIENCY OF USE
Very long scrolling of the product page. It is difficult to navigate and search for the necessary information and to navigate to the characteristics and reviews

CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS
Non-typical usage of a drop-down for choosing the number of units

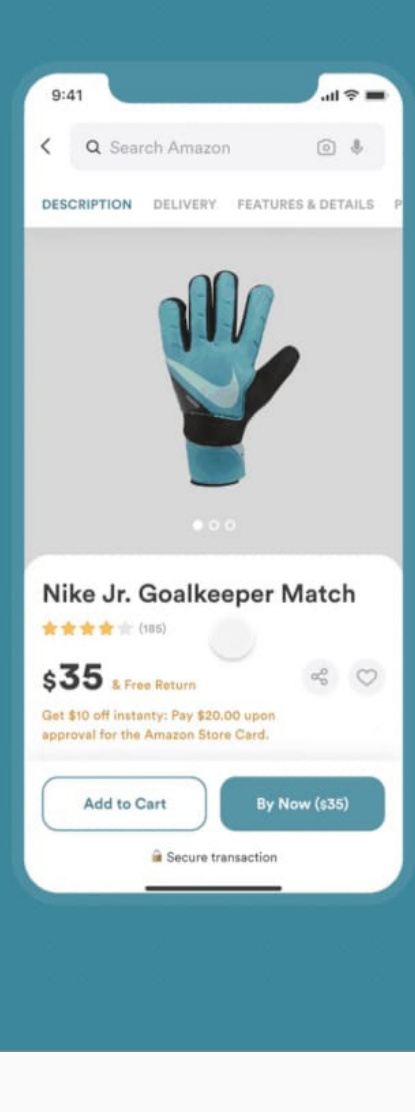
AESTHETIC AND MINIMALIST DESIGN
Many different font styles (color, size, thickness). Small text, not ideal for people with poor eyesight

Upgrade design

PRODUCT PAGE

CHANGES MADE TO DESIGN

- ✓ A single format for displaying the choice of color and size for all types of goods
- ✓ Standardized colors, fonts, elements and sizes
- ✓ Added a sizing table to make it easier for the user to navigate
- ✓ Added page navigation and changed the page structure



Current design

FILTERS

POSITIVE FINDINGS

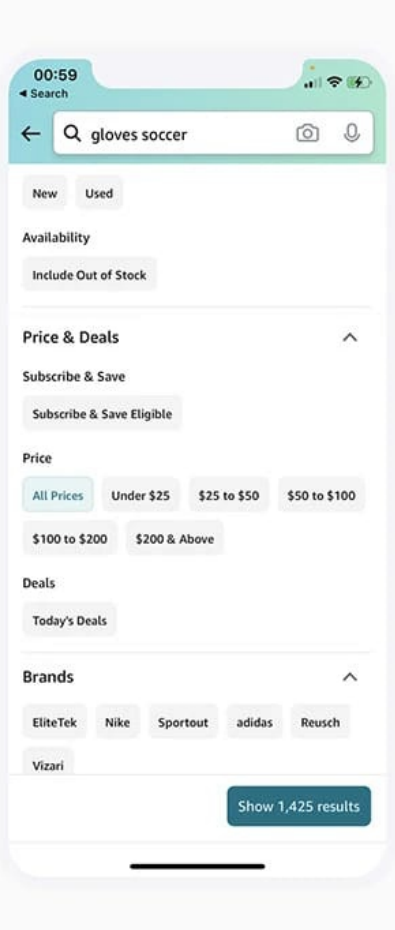
- ✓ There are filter categories that separate content among themselves
- ✓ The user understands which of the filters is currently applied

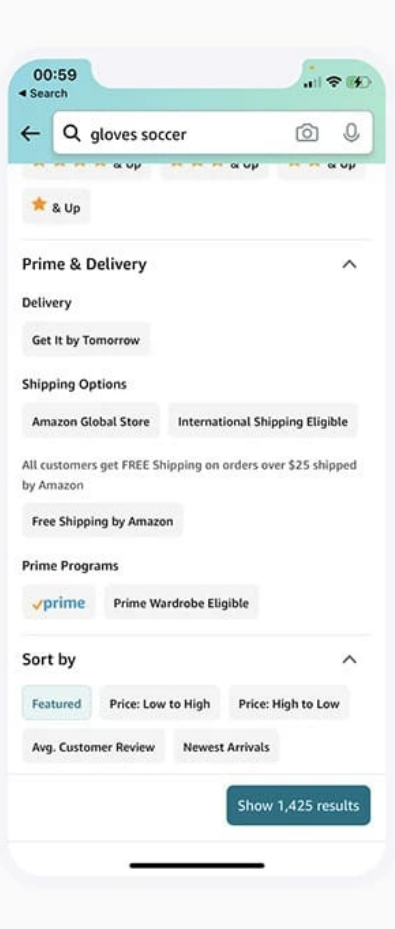
NEGATIVE FINDINGS

USER CONTROL AND FREEDOM
Users are unable to choose the price range that unable to need (can't choose a price less than $30)

USER CONTROL AND FREEDOM
Unable to exit filters without applying them and there is no exit button

USER CONTROL AND FREEDOM
"Sport & outdoor" - the name of the filter does not match what can be filtered here





NEGATIVE FINDINGS

CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS
Clicking the "back" button returns to the previous page without closing the open filter

CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS
Strange to see sorting inside filters. There is usually a separate feature for that

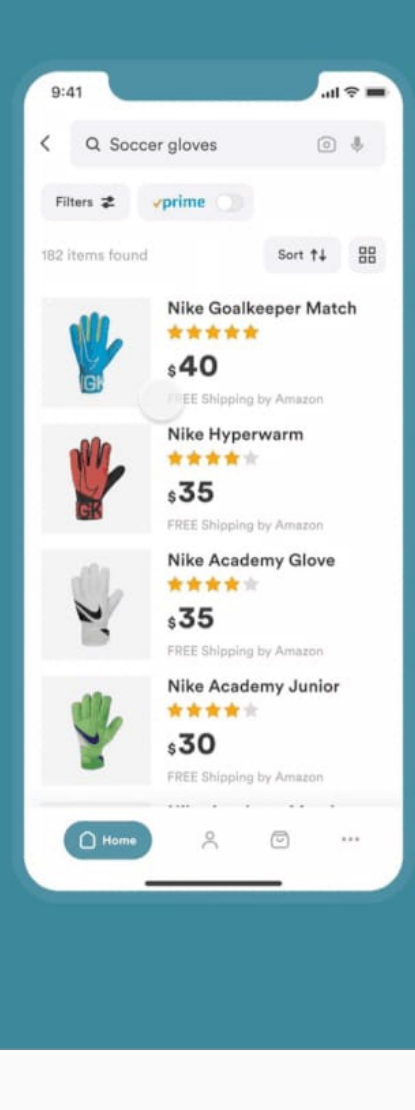
MATCH BETWEEN SYSTEM AND THE REAL WORLD
Expectation of more specific filters on a category, such as sizes, but it seems like the filter is quite generic/has been derived from one country's sizing taxonomy

Upgrade design

FILTERS

CHANGES MADE TO DESIGN

- ✓ Added the ability to add a custom price range
- ✓ Clearer names for filters and blocks
- ✓ Standardized behavior pattern for filters
- ✓ Sorting is rendered as a separate screen element



Current design

CART PAGE

POSITIVE FINDINGS

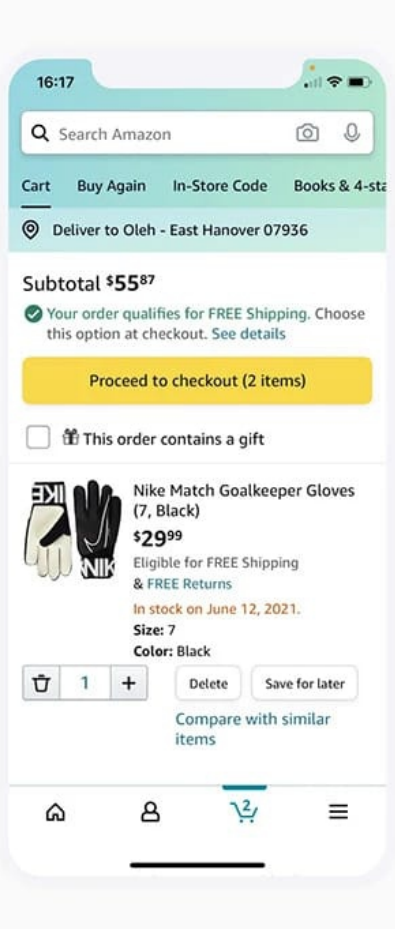
- ✓ User sees the total number of selected goods
- ✓ Includes all the necessary info about the product
- ✓ Return Possibility Message

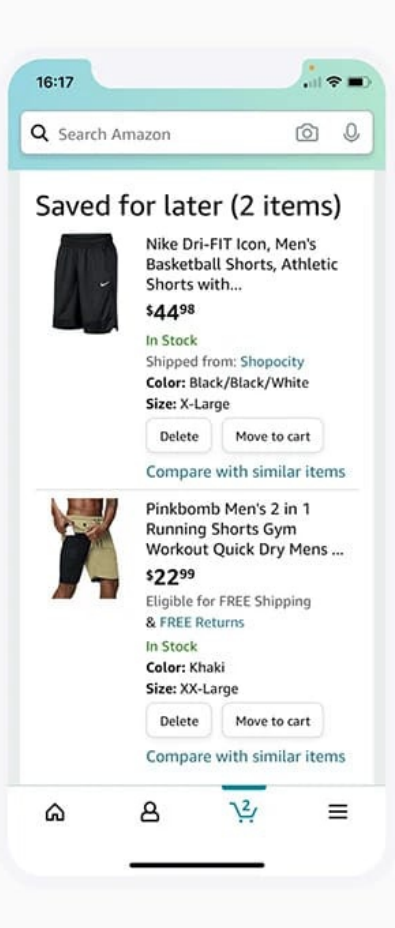
NEGATIVE FINDINGS

CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS
The price for products is shown above them

CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS
The checkout button is above the items in the cart. Usually, people read from top to bottom

CONSISTENCY AND STANDARDS
Quantity selection is implemented differently than on the product page


16:17
Search Amazon
Cart
Buy Again
In-Store Code
Deliver to Oleh - East Hanover 07936
Subtotal $55.87
Your order qualifies for FREE Shipping. Choose this option at checkout. See details
Proceed to checkout (2 items)
This order contains a gift
Nike Match Goalkeeper Gloves (7, Black)
$29.99
Eligible for FREE Shipping
& FREE Returns
In stock on June 12, 2021.
Size: 7
Color: Black
Delete
Save for later
Compare with similar items


16:17
Search Amazon
Saved for later (2 items)
Nike Dri-FIT Icon, Men's Basketball Shorts, Athletic Shorts with...
$44.98
In Stock
Shipped from: Shopocity
Color: Black/Black/White
Size: X-Large
Delete
Move to cart
Compare with similar items
Pinkbomb Men's 2 in 1 Running Shorts Gym Workout Quick Dry Mens ...
$22.99
Eligible for FREE Shipping
& FREE Returns
In Stock
Color: Khaki
Size: XX-Large
Delete
Move to cart
Compare with similar items

NEGATIVE FINDINGS

ERROR PREVENTION
The 'delete' button is not highlighted, making it easy to be accidentally clicked on

ERROR PREVENTION
Unable to quickly return a deleted item to the cart

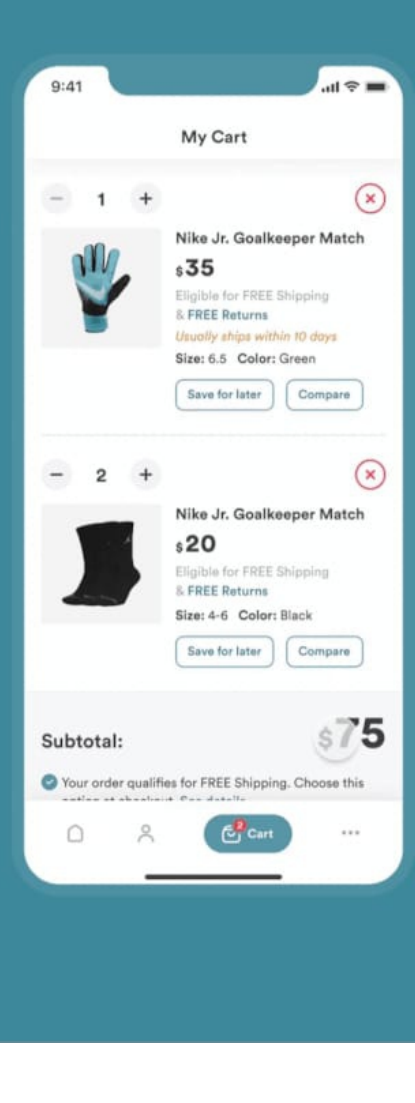
AESTHETIC AND MINIMALIST DESIGN
Elements look like a random mess (different contours, filters, thickness, size) – little space

Upgrade design

CART PAGE

CHANGES MADE TO DESIGN

- ✓ Checkout button and total amount moved down below items
- ✓ Used only consistent elements, colors and sizes, added space between content
- ✓ After removing an item from the cart, the user can return it back
- ✓ The 'delete' button is now more explicit to prevent the user from accidentally clicking on it


9:41
My Cart
Nike Jr. Goalkeeper Match
$35
Eligible for FREE Shipping
& FREE Returns
Usually ships within 10 days
Size: 6.5 Color: Green
Save for later
Compare
Nike Jr. Goalkeeper Match
$20
Eligible for FREE Shipping
& FREE Returns
Size: 4-6 Color: Black
Save for later
Compare
Subtotal:
$75
Your order qualifies for FREE Shipping. Choose this
Cart

Team

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